the outlines of the massive clock tower above the station. Léa noted a German soldier making his way along the aisle, checking tickets. She lifted theirs from her bag, ready to show him.

"Is this Archimedes Company in Berlin?" Rose asked, her hand moving swiftly over the paper. "Maître Mallon arranged that we shouldn't be in a big city. Where are we going?"

"Not Berlin. Let me check . . . it's in a town called Glashütte—"

"*Ausweispapiere und Zugtickets, bitte*," the German soldier said.

Léa presented their tickets and papers. He studied them, then looked at Rose.

"*Nein, nicht erlaubt*," he said, wagging a stout finger at her.

"What's wrong?" Léa asked. Then she remembered what had happened to Rose on the quai and told her to put down her pencil. "You're not allowed to draw."

"*Französisch sprechen ist hier verboten*," he said, turning back to Léa.

"*Ja*," Léa said, nodding her head in agreement.

The soldier's gaze fixed on Rose before he returned the documents to Léa and moved on.

"What else did he say?"

"Hush," Léa whispered to Rose. Léa then took Rose's pencil from her hand and, using the back of the sketchpad, wrote in small letters: *Speaking French is forbidden.*

"*Ja*," Rose said, turning to the window. The sisters sat in silence, staring at the strange, unfamiliar world outside.

Rose put a finger to the glass, drawing Léa's attention to a large poster fixed to the station wall. It depicted a German soldier in solid black, his steel helmet low over his forehead. Mouth closed, he held an index finger to his lips, a gesture that seemed to carry a silent threat. Below him, in bold, she saw three German words: *Spione, Verräter, Saboteure*. Though she could guess the first and third words, the one in the middle was utterly foreign. She looked at Léa, who wrote: Beware of Spies, Traitors, and Saboteurs.

As the train pulled out of the station, Léa wrote another message on the back of Rose's sketchbook. *Now we're the foreigners. Like we didn't trust them in Orléans, they don't trust us here.* Rose read it, nodded and pressed closer to the window in silent acknowledgment of this new world.